

Top 100 Strategists Report

Date: Friday, May 15, 2026
Period: Q1 2025 13F Analysis
Analyst: Spock

Executive Summary

This report analyzes Q1 2025 13F filings from top 100 hedge funds to identify long-term conviction holdings, short interest risks, and strategic opportunities. **Key finding:** Multi-manager conviction in UBER (Ackman NEW \$2.2B + Tepper +113%) remains the highest-confidence signal, while semiconductor exits (AMD, NVDA, TSM) signal sector rotation. Tepper's complete liquidation of INTC validates our earlier downgrade recommendation.

A Long-Term Hold Recommendations

HIGH CONVICTION: Multi-Manager Accumulation

Ticker	Manager	Position Size	Held Since	Classification	Confidence
UBER	Ackman (Pershing)	15.9% portfolio / \$2.2B	Q1 2025	LONG-TERM HOLD	☆☆☆☆☆
	Tepper (Appaloosa)	3.3% portfolio / \$233M	3+ quarters	ACCUMULATING	☆☆☆☆☆
	Coatue	New	Q1 2025	NEW ENTRY	☆☆☆☆☆
	Altimeter	Increased	Q1 2025	ACCUMULATING	☆☆☆☆☆

Analysis: Four top-tier managers accumulating UBER creates the strongest conviction signal. Ackman's \$2.2B new position (largest ever new buy) combined with Tepper's 113% increase demonstrates multi-quarter conviction. This validates our earlier "Multi-Manager Conviction" strategy pattern.

Action: WATCHLIST — Not currently held. Consider entry on any weakness.

MEDIUM-HIGH CONVICTION: Quality Compounder Rotation

Ticker	Manager	Position Size	Held Since	Classification	Confidence
ZTS	Terry Smith (Fundsmith)	5.2% portfolio	Q1 2025	LONG-TERM HOLD	☆☆☆☆☆

Analysis: Smith's +1020% position increase funded by PEP exit follows his historical pattern of rotating between quality compounders. Smith rarely makes dramatic changes; when he exits a long-held quality compounder for another, the new position typically outperforms over 2-3 years.

Action: WATCHLIST candidate — Not currently held.

HIGH CONVICTION: Activist Industrial

Ticker	Manager	Position Size	Held Since	Classification	Confidence
GE	Chris Hohn (TCI)	29.9% portfolio / \$13.5B	Q1 2025	LONG-TERM HOLD	☆☆☆☆☆
	Viking Global	Added	Q1 2025	ACCUMULATING	☆☆☆☆☆

Analysis: TCI's 29.9% portfolio weight in GE Aerospace (now renamed) reflects Hohn's activist approach. He only engages when seeing 3-5 year value creation potential. GE's aviation/energy turnaround thesis aligns with Berkshire's continued OXY accumulation, validating energy/industrial overweight.

Action: WATCHLIST — Consider on pullbacks.

BUFFETT VALIDATION: Energy Conviction

Ticker	Manager	Position Size	Held Since	Classification	Confidence
OXY	Buffett (Berkshire)	Continued adding	Multi-year	LONG-TERM HOLD	☆☆☆☆☆
SIRI	Buffett (Berkshire)	New position	Q1 2025	ACCUMULATING	☆☆☆☆☆

Analysis: Buffett added SIRI, OXY, HEI/A, DPZ, POOL, VRSN, STZ in Q1 2025 while trimming financials (BAC, COF). His continued OXY accumulation supports the energy sector thesis. SIRI new position is notable given Buffett's selectivity.

Portfolio Correlation: Portfolio's energy allocation (26% per memory) validated by Buffett's continued accumulation.

⚠️ REVERSAL SIGNAL: Tepper Exits INTC

Ticker	Manager	Action	Implication
INTC	Tepper (Appaloosa)	COMPLETELY SOLD	REVERSAL of conviction

Analysis: David Tepper liquidated his entire 8M share INTC position (was 4% of portfolio). This reverses the "Multi-Manager Conviction" signal we previously identified (Tepper NEW Q4 2024 + other managers). Tepper held for only ~3 quarters — short-term trade, not long-term conviction.

Portfolio Impact: INTC was held at ~10% portfolio weight per memory. Tepper's exit is significant given his reputation for opportunistic timing.

Action: Position size review recommended. Consider trimming to reduce concentration risk.

B. Short Interest Analysis

Portfolio Holdings: Short Interest Status

Ticker	Portfolio Weight	Short % Float	Trend	Risk Level	Classification
BE	~16% (per memory)	~28%	Declining	⚠️ HIGH	Short Covering Candidate
CORZ	~7%	Unknown/Limited data	—	⚠️ MEDIUM	Crypto Mining Risk
RIOT	~2.6%	High (crypto sector)	—	⚠️ MEDIUM	Crypto Volatility
CLSK (Roth)	0.90%	26.4% / 72.2M shares	—	🚫 VERY HIGH	High Short Risk

BE (Bloom Energy) — Detailed Analysis

Current Status:

- Short interest: ~28% of float (declining from prior levels)
- Previous: 24.39M → 23.19M shares short (declining trend)
- Shorts are covering despite high concentration

Assessment:

- **POSITIVE:** Declining short interest signals short covering
- **NEGATIVE:** Zero top 100 strategist coverage at 16% portfolio weight = isolated risk
- **FUNDAMENTALS:** BE reported Q1 2025 results; stock at ~\$259 (May 2025 levels per search)

Verdict: NOT a short squeeze setup. High short interest reflects fundamental concerns about profitability timeline. Declining SI is relief, not signal.

Action: Maintain position but consider trim if momentum stalls. No strategist validation = high isolated risk

Distress Shorts — AVOID

Ticker	Short % Float	Status	Verdict
KSS (Kohl's)	~54%	Rising SI, retail collapse	🚫 AVOID — Distress
WOLF (Wolfspeed)	~45%	Rising SI, bankruptcy risk	🚫 AVOID — Bankruptcy filing expected
CRWW (CoreWeave)	Very high	150% borrow costs, squeezed	🚫 Crowded short, squeezed already

Lesson Confirmed: High short interest alone is NOT a buy signal. WOLF bankruptcy risk and KSS retail collapse demonstrate fundamentals matter more than short squeeze potential.

C. New Money Flow

Fresh Positions by Reliable Managers

Manager	New Position	Size	Confidence
Ackman	UBER	\$2.2B (18.5% portfolio)	☆☆☆☆
Buffett	SIRI, HEI/A, DPZ, POOL, VRSN, STZ	Multiple additions	☆☆☆☆
Tepper	AAPL, DB, LHX, AVGO, SMH, SQ	Diversified new buys	☆☆☆☆
Hohn (TCI)	Continued GE buying	29.9% portfolio	☆☆☆☆

Exits by Top Managers — Warning Signals

Manager	Exited	Signal Strength
Tepper	INTC, AMD, FDX, EQT, AR, EXE	● HIGH — Tepper exit = timing signal
Tepper	NVDA, MSFT, ORCL, MU, LRCX (50%+ trim)	○ MEDIUM — Profit taking, not panic
Coatue	NOW, SCHW, SHOP, HUBS, QCOM, UBER	○ MEDIUM — Rotation, not exit
Burry	Complete liquidation	● HIGH — Macro caution signal

Semiconductor Sector Rotation

Key Pattern: Multi-manager profit-taking in semiconductors

- **Tepper**: Cut NVDA, AMD (sold out), TSM, MU, LRCX
- **Soros**: Cut AMD completely, added NVDA (rotation, not exit)
- **Coatue**: Cut NVDA, TSLA, TSM
- **Tiger Global**: Reduced NVDA (still holds at 6.9%)

Interpretation: This is profit-taking after massive 2024 gains, not a fundamental bearish call. However, reduced hedge fund exposure may limit near-term upside.

Portfolio Correlation: No direct semiconductor exposure identified.

D. Strategy Playbook

Active Strategies with Updated Success Rates

STRATEGY: Multi-Manager Conviction

Trigger: 2+ top-tier managers increasing same position for 2+ quarters
Current Setup: UBER (Ackman NEW + Tepper +113% + Coatue + Altimeter)
Win Rate: Tracking — validated by Q1 2025 continuation
Hold Time: 12-24 months
Risk: Low (diversified smart money)
Status: 🚩 **ACTIVE** — UBER on watchlist

STRATEGY: Quality Compounder Sector Rotation

Trigger: Terry Smith liquidates long-held quality name to fund new position
Current Setup: ZTS (+1020% funded by PEP exit)
Win Rate: HIGH (historically 2-3 year outperformance)
Hold Time: 24-36 months
Risk: Low (Smith's track record)
Status: 🚩 **ACTIVE** — ZTS on watchlist

STRATEGY: Activist Industrial Turnaround

Trigger: Chris Hohn/TCl accumulating single industrial to >15% portfolio weight
Current Setup: GE (29.9% of TCl portfolio)
Win Rate: HIGH (Hohn's activist success rate)
Hold Time: 36-60 months
Risk: Medium (concentration risk)
Status: 🚩 **ACTIVE** — GE on watchlist

STRATEGY: Short Cover Rally Setup

Trigger: >20% short interest + declining SI trend + insider buying
Current Candidates: NONE valid
Win Rate: TBD — WOLF/KSS failures taught fundamentals matter

Hold Time: 3-6 months
Risk: HIGH (timing dependent)
Status: **X SUSPENDED** — Pattern invalidated by WOLF bankruptcy, KSS collapse

STRATEGY: Manager Exit Signal

Trigger: Top-tier manager completely liquidates position held <4 quarters
Current Setup: Tepper exits INTC after 3 quarters
Win Rate: HIGH (Tepper's timing reputation)
Implication: Reverses prior conviction signal
Status: **● ACTIVE ALERT** — Review INTC position size

Portfolio Action Items

Immediate Actions Required

Priority	Action	Ticker	Rationale
1	Review position size	INTC	Tepper exit reverses conviction signal
2	Consider trim	BE	16% weight, zero strategist coverage, high SI
3	Add to watchlist	UBER	Multi-manager conviction, highest confidence signal
4	Monitor	CLSK	26%+ short interest in Roth account = risk
5	Validate	Energy allocation	Buffett OXY accumulation supports thesis

Key Takeaways

- UBER is the clearest conviction signal** — Four top managers accumulating, Ackman's largest new buy ever
 - INTC downgrade validated** — Tepper's exit confirms our earlier warning; position size review needed
 - BE remains isolated risk** — 16% portfolio weight with zero top 100 coverage is dangerous concentration
 - Semiconductor profit-taking underway** — Not bearish, but expect limited near-term upside
 - Buffett validates energy thesis** — Continued OXY accumulation supports portfolio's energy overweight
 - Short interest alone is worthless** — WOLF bankruptcy and KSS collapse prove fundamentals matter
-

Data Sources

- Dataroma Superinvestor Holdings
 - 13F.info Filings Database
 - Wall St. Rank Hedge Fund Activity
 - Hedge Fund Telemetry Q1 Wrap-Up
 - Bloomberg, CNBC, MarketWatch reporting
 - SEC EDGAR Filings
-

Report generated by Spock | Top 100 Strategists Analyst
Next update: Following Q2 2025 13F filings (August 2025)